Johanna Hölzl

PhD candidate in Sociology at the University of Mannheim
researching the quality and opportunities of new data sources and methods for the social sciences

johanna@hoelzl.email | johannahoelzl.github.io

johanna-hoelzl | johannahoelzl | 0009-0002-4954-2209 | Scholar

Experience

University of Mannheim *2022 - present*
Research Associate and Lecturer Mannheim, Germany

- Empirical Research Course I and II (Spring and Fall 2023 and 2024)
- Data Collection Exercise Course (Fall 2022, 2023, 2024, and 2025)
- Bachelor Thesis Colloquium and Thesis Supervision (Spring 2024, 2025, and 2026)
- Independent course development and coordination, including development of course schedules and materials, implementation of GenAI/LLM components, coordination of content across parallel courses and years, and term paper grading

University of Mannheim and Mannheim Center for European Social Research *2021 - 2023*
Research Associate Mannheim, Germany

- Project `"Integration research 2.0"` on new data sources in migration and integration research
- Working on the methodological challenges, reliability, and validity of Google Trends data

Leibniz-Institut für Bildungsverläufe e.V. *2021*
Research Associate Bamberg, Germany

- ReGes project on refugee's educational trajectories in Germany
- Support in the process of data collection and validation

Leibniz-Institut für Bildungsverläufe e.V. *2015 - 2020*
Student Research Assistant Bamberg, Germany

- ReGes project and other departments
- Support in the process of data collection, data analysis, and paper writing

University of Trento *2020*
Internship Trento, Italy

- Department of Sociology and Social Research
- Data cleaning and harmonization of longitudinal data

European Parliament *2017*
Internship Brussels, Belgium

- Office of Ismail Ertug, MEP
- Support in legislative, administrative, and organizational tasks in two committees

Education

University of Mannheim *2021 - present*
PhD candidate Mannheim, Germany

- Chair of Social Data Science and Methodology, Supervisor Prof. Florian Keusch
- Dissertation on "What We Can and Cannot Do: The Quality and Opportunities of New Data Sources and Methods in Social Science Research"

University of Bamberg and University of Trento *2018 - 2021*
M.A. Sociology and Laurea Magistrale Sociology and Social Research Bamberg, Germany and Trento, Italy

- Grade: 1.0 (GPA: 4.0), ranked 1st in cohort

University of Bamberg *2014 - 2018*
B.A. Sociology Bamberg, Germany

- Grade: 1.2 (GPA: 3.8)

Publications

[1] Johanna Hölzl, Florian Keusch, John Collins (2026). **Where You Are Is What You Get! Inconsistencies of Digital Trace Data Across Download Locations**. *Social Science Computer Review* 0(0). DOI: 10.1177/08944393261469494

[2] Birgit Zeyer Gliozzo, Johanna Hölzl, Gundula Zoch, Philipp Doebler (2026). **"My (22m) Girlfriend (23f) Comes Home and Does Nothing" - Using LLMs to Study Gendered Perceptions of Paid and Unpaid Work in Reddit Relationship Discussions**. *Preprint*. Under Review in *Computational Communication Research*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/qf7j8_v1

[3] Johanna Hölzl, Florian Keusch, Christoph Sajons (2025). **The (mis)use of Google Trends data in the social sciences — A systematic review, critique, and recommendations**. *Social Science Research* 126(103099). DOI: 10.1016/j.ssresearch.2024.103099

[4] Johanna Hölzl, Daria Szafran, Florian Keusch (2025). **Digital Inequalities in Germany**. *GESIS Data Archive*. DOI: 10.7802/2915

[5] Johanna Hölzl, Marie-Lou Sohnius (2023). **Spotify API**. In *APIs for social scientists: A collaborative review*, edited by P. C. Bauer, C. Landesvatter, and L. Behrens.

In Preparation

Johanna Hölzl, Ruben Bach (2026). **Manterrupted? A Multimodal Analysis of Gendered Interview Dynamics in German Political Podcasts**. To be submitted to *New Media & Society* in December 2026.

Conference presentations, posters, and invited talks

Meeting of the CS3 lab for Computational Survey and Social Science — *May 19, 2026*
Still problematic? Generalizability, validity, and reliability of API-based research (invited talk) — online

General Online Research Conference 2026 (GOR 26) — *February 26-27, 2026*
`"My (22m) Girlfriend (23f) Comes Home and Does Nothing"` — Gendered Perceptions of Paid and Household Labor in Reddit Relationship Discussions over Time (poster presentation) — Cologne, Germany

11th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC^2S^2) — *July 21-24, 2025*
Where You Are Is What You Get? Sample Inconsistencies of Digital Trace Data Across Download Locations (poster presentation) — Norrköping, Sweden

2025 Conference of the European Survey Research Association (ESRA) — *July 14-18, 2025*
Where You Are Is What You Get? Sample Inconsistencies of Digital Trace Data Across Download Locations (presentation) — Utrecht, Netherlands

General Online Research Conference 2025 (GOR 25) — *March 31-April 02, 2025*
Where You Are Is What You Get? Sample Inconsistencies of Google Trends Data Across Download Locations (presentation) — Berlin, Germany

79th Annual Conference of the American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR) — *May 15-17, 2024*
Where You Are Is What You Get? Sample Inconsistencies of Google Trends Data Across Download Locations (poster presentation) — Atlanta, USA

General Online Research Conference 2023 (GOR 23) — *September 20-22, 2023*
What do racists google? A systematic approach to selecting and validating Google Trends data using the example of xenophobic attitudes (presentation) — Kassel, Germany

GESIS course on "Data Science Tools for Survey Researchers" — *August 22, 2023*
The (mis)use of Google Trends data in the social sciences - A systematic review, critique, and guidelines (invited talk) — Mannheim, Germany

2023 Conference of the European Survey Research Association (ESRA) — *July 17-21, 2023*
Sustainable Trend or Trending Mayfly? A Systematic Literature Review and Guidelines on Using Google Trends Data for Social Science Research (presentation) — Milan, Italy

Research Plus by the German Society for Online Research (DGOF) — *June 12, 2023*
Wonach googeln Rassisten? Chancen und Herausforderungen von Google Trends Daten für die Forschung (invited talk) — Mannheim, Germany

78th Annual Conference of the American Association for Public Opinion Research (AAPOR) — *May 10-12, 2023*
What do racists google? A systematic approach to selecting and validating Google Trends data using the example of xenophobic attitudes (presentation) — Philadelphia, USA

Awards

GESS Publication of the Year Award *2025*
Graduate School of Economic and Social Sciences (GESS), University of Mannheim

- Awarded for the publication "The (mis)use of Google Trends data in the social sciences – A systematic review, critique, and recommendations"
- Endowed with 1000€

ABS^2 Preis für Abschlussarbeiten *2022*
Alumni-Verein der Bamberger Soziologie und Survey-Statistik (ABS^2 e.V.)

- Awarded the price for the best Master thesis for "Additionally disadvantaged? The effect of technological change on the impact of a migration background on labor market outcomes across Europe"
- Endowed with 200€

Community Activities and Service

Peer Review *2022 - now*
Conferences and Journals including Social Science Computer Review, Sociological Methods & Research, Social Sciences & Humanities Open, PLOS One, Survey Methods: Insights from the Field, AAPOR, and ESRA [🌐]

Deputy Equal Opportunities Officer for the Social Sciences *2022 - now*
University of Mannheim

- Appointment committee member for new social science professorships
- Co-organization of workshops on diversity and equality in research and teaching at the University of Mannheim

Conference Co-Organizer *2025*
Mannheim Center for European Social Research

- Hybrid conference on "Novel Data Sources, New Methods and Computational Approaches for Understanding Discrimination and Bias"
- Co-organized with Nicole Schwitter, Daria Szafran, and Johanna Gereke

Organizing Committee Member of DataFest Germany *2024 and 2026*
University of Mannheim

- Co-organized a data science hackathon for ∼70 students
- Responsible for the coordination of students, teams, scheduling, and organizational infrastructure

Conference Session Organizer *2023*
10th ESRA Conference, Milan, Italy

- Session on Applications, Potentials, and Challenges when Using Google Trends in Combination or as Substitute for Surveys
- Co-organized with Florian Keusch

Skills

- **Programming Languages:** R, Python, Stata
- **Software:** Version control with Git, LaTeX, Unipark, MAXQDA
- **Languages:** German (Native proficiency), English (Business fluent), French (Fluent), Italian (Basics)